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**r/GooglePixel** • 8mo ago
optimistprime3

Another Pixel6a sets itself on fire while charging overnight, 6/3/25

Three nights ago when I went to bed, my Pixel6a was below 20%, so I put it on its regular charger and went to sleep. I have an Amazon [essentials](#) 9W basic wall plug, but the one that came with the phone either got misplaced or broke a while ago. I only put this phone into use in February 2023, bought it new, directly from Google Fi, have paid for device protection and haven't had any water damage or tell-tale signs of a pending [r/spicypillow](#)

About 5-6 hours later, I was jolted awake at 4am to the sound of my phone screaming its overheating noise at the volume I'd set for my alarm, in addition to the strange sound of the insides of the phone blasting out the right side, accompanied by the horrific smell of burning chemicals and electronics. From a dead sleep, that serves as an incredibly effective but horribly stressful wake-up system, 0/5. Despite the initial confusion at all of this, I managed to find the phone in the dark very quickly. It was incredibly hot and I honestly don't know how it didn't burn me as I tossed it away from me onto the tile floor.

That got it away from flammable things but closer to my smoke detector, setting that off about a second later. I turned on a light, grabbed the side of the phone that wasn't melting and chucked the still smoking and sizzling Pixelbomb outside on my concrete patio. As I later discovered, the phone had actually started a small fire on some of my clothes before I got it off the charger and to the floor. It melted some gym shorts and another shirt was melted to those, while the cotton fabrics that were nearby had burn holes and singe marks. The charger itself is fine, and the charging port on the phone is damage-free.

If I hadn't been just a few feet away from the phone to act as quickly as I had, I would've been dealing with a nasty house fire. If this happens to someone who's not able to quickly remove their burning phone and get it to a non-flammable surface, it will be catastrophic.

Here are some of the photos of the culprit and the damage. I'm so grateful I could act quickly because this couldn't have burned for more than 3 seconds before I reached the phone: https://ibb.co/album/6n2y1b?sort=name_asc



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341

121

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Search Comments

**sanjosanjo** • 8mo ago

I have a 6a and I'm concerned that this post starts with "another". I didn't realize it has been repeatable.

**ToSeeAgainAgainAgain** • 8mo ago

P8P

[Skip to main content](#)[+](#) Create**Narrow-Analysis-9661** • 8mo ago

Ok, yeah, except that this is major issue on 6a as well as battery swell

**optimistprime3** OP • 8mo ago

https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1knwuh8/my_google_pixel_6a_spontaneously_com_busted_in_the/ This was just 3 weeks ago.

**fajron123** • 8mo ago

That one looks like the battery was swollen before it went boom. Yours doesnt look swollen, at least from thr front

**SonnySwanson** • 8mo ago

Pixel 6a

As a fellow 6a owner, I think that I'm going to get an oven mitt and some kind of fire blanket for my bedside table.

**NSMike** • 8mo ago

Pixel 8 Pro

Bucket o' sand

**[deleted]** • 8mo ago

Even better, do not charge it overnight. I stopped doing that with any phone. I charge it during a time I'm awake and someone is near the phone all the time. Usually just when I start working (WFH for life!). Oh and I definitely would not put it near something that catches fire easy when charging.

I used to charge overnight too. The probability of something like that happening to me is very small, it's just that the outcome can be catastrophic. Small probability times catastrophic outcome is still pretty bad.

The same applies to any battery. No phone, laptop, or ebike battery gets charged overnight in our household.

**UrFavoriteFaget** • 8mo ago

Pixel 6 Pro

I worked in a phone shop on tech support for Geek squad. I got told by the manufacturers of these phones that the live demo ones on the wall had a charge limit for this reason.

Regardless they all still had the same issues with bloated spicy pillows. Never ever plug your phone in overnight & never put it on a bed/fabric/under a pillow etc. One that specifically had to be constantly replaced was the Nexus 6P as this would swell first. Not once, every single time

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)

1 more reply

**Baconandpolitics** • 8mo ago

Imagine if u weren't home omg! How is google handling this for you?

**optimistprime3** OP • 8mo ago

Google Support offered me an 8a as a replacement. However, every 6a/7a/8a/9a uses the same battery type, Li-Po, and all of those phones have reported overheating issues. I've told them that I - quite understandably, given this experience - don't want a phone with that battery as a replacement and suggested a newer Samsung model that Google Fi offers, with a Li-Ion battery instead.

**Pure-Recover70** • 8mo ago

G1; Nexus One,S,5X; Pixel 2XL,4a,6a,7Pro,8Pro,9ProXL

You'll be 'happy' to hear that Li-Ion does actually also potentially suffer from the same issue... It's a generic issue with basically all high capacity batteries... These things are basically miniature bombs... and have a tendency to occasionally/randomly, though very rarely, suffer from runaway critical reactions - yes it's more likely when hot, or when mechanically damaged, but sometimes you just get really unlucky...

**optimistprime3** OP • 8mo ago**ShakenButNotStirred** • 8mo ago

I'm assuming you asked them for the A36 or maybe S25, but it's kind of crazy to me that they offered you the P8a and not the P9a, and honestly they should bump you to the P9 or P9P out of goodwill, and especially if you're sending the P6a in to them for analysis.

Maybe try reaching out to [u/PixelCommunity](#) and see if they can do better.

**nathderbyshire** • 8mo ago

Pixel 10

Top 1% Commenter

Bullshit they can't even offer the latest version for something as serious as this, even the a series. Stock clearance isn't a top priority oml

**optimistprime3** OP • 8mo ago • Edited 8mo ago

That's how I was seeing it, too. I've been a Google Fi subscriber since 2018 and had device protection on the phone I bought through them. After having what they called a "melting incident," the entirety of the 2 hours I was on with chat support was spent gathering data from me about the phone and its usage, but when I asked what replacement options I would have, they told me to wait 24-48 hours to hear from support via email. 40+ hours later, they offer an 8a and ask for me to send the burned one back.

[Skip to main content](#)

Create



you" as of their last response.

I'll reach out to [u/PixelCommunity](#) since the standard channels have been pretty disappointing and very slow to respond.

ETA: Ah, I guess they have to reach out first.

**TrollyDodger55** • 8mo ago

Get a good charger



2 more replies

**PadyEos** • 8mo ago

However, every 6a/7a/8a/9a uses the same battery type, Li-Po, and all of those phones have reported overheating issues

I wouldn't read too much into that. I have a 7a and my wife a 6a and frankly they are running and charging cooler than all flagships I ever had since the Sony Xperia K800i brick phone.

The 6a has a lithium-ion battery also. It's been that standard smartphone battery technology for forever since it came out a long time ago.

You were very unlucky. The odds of that happening twice to you are now astronomically low. Enjoy your new phone.

**BizzyM** • 8mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

suggested a newer Samsung model that Google Fi offers, with a Li-Ion battery instead

I would hold off on that, bud: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OfM0GqsIB6c>

**Baconandpolitics** • 8mo ago

Well that seems like a reasonable request! Keep us updated



3 more replies

**fajron123** • 8mo ago

When you get a response from google please update us. I also have a 6a 🤔

[Skip to main content](#)

Create

**flipside1o1** • 8mo ago

Don't look up how often people die falling down stairs

**SSDeemer** • 8mo ago • Edited 8mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

For overnight charging, I use the lowest-possible charger that I have, 5 Watts, stopping at 80%. While charging, my Pixel 6a barely gets above ambient temperature. After 3 years, Accubattery reports battery health at 98%

**nathderbyshire** • 8mo ago

Pixel 10 Top 1% Commenter

They really need to make adaptive charging more manual so you can use a fast cable and it'll default to low power until you tell it not too. But it's based on routines and vibes for now

**schnokobaer** • 8mo ago

Pixel 8

Do you mean 5 Watts? 5 A is crazy high. My most powerful chargers (60 W, 45 W) all top out at 3 A (5V=>15W, 9V=>27W, 15V=>45W, 20V=>60W)

**SSDeemer** • 8mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

Yes. Thank you for catching my error. Five amps would be absurdly high. Post corrected.

**plastic_toast** • 8mo ago

Nevermind house fires - outside of a worst worst case scenario you and everyone else can likely escape, and you'll presumably be insured.

But what if this happened on a plane?

**Efficient_Loss_9928** • 8mo ago

This is why you NEVER pack electronic devices in checked baggage.

In the cabin everything would be fine, it is controllable, but nobody can control a fire in the baggage compartment.

**Pure-Recover70** • 8mo ago

G1; Nexus One,S,5X; Pixel 2XL,4a,6a,7Pro,8Pro,9ProXL

[Skip to main content](#)

Create



As an example: you can transport a wireless power drill (or other power tool) by plane, but the battery *must* be removed and in carry on (so you notice if it goes up in flames), and the drill itself must be checked (so you can't drill a hole into the plane).

**Erigion** • 8mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

Some airlines have containment bags on their planes which should contain the fire to some degree.

Otherwise, toss it in a restroom sink?

**plastic_toast** • 8mo ago

I'd assume "portable devices" catching fire must have happened a few times in recent years, yet we haven't had a plane crash in the west for a long long time. Last fatal commercial airliner crash in the UK was 1989.

I'd assume fire regs, etc are good, and you'd initiate an emergency descent.

**Tiek00n** • 8mo ago

(Phone 1 -> 4a -> 7 -> 10 Pro, Watch 2, Buds A-Series)

For PEDs (Portable Electronic Device) that catch fire, having them go into the fire containment bags should be enough that it doesn't require the flight to divert. Many (most?) airlines have policies that do not allow you to put battery-based electronics in the overhead bins because it can be harder to notice immediately if one happens to catch on fire.

[+ 3 more replies](#)**Erigion** • 8mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

Yes, li-on battery fires do happen on planes. Hence the ban on having them in checked bags.

<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/hazardous-materials-airplanes/>

Some carriers are now requiring batteries to be in sight while they're being used.

<https://www.afar.com/magazine/why-cant-lithium-batteries-go-in-your-checked-luggage>

**skelextrac** • 8mo ago

There's a reason the FAA has numerous regulations about traveling with rechargeable batteries.

**pichael288** • 8mo ago**evilspoons** • 8mo ago

Pixel 8a



Top 1% Commenter

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**PixelCommunity** • 8mo ago

Official Google Account Top 1% Commenter

Hey, can you please check your [inbox](#)? I just sent you a private message.

**[deleted]** • 8mo ago**Mypopsecrets** • 7mo ago

That's crazy, I have the 6a with the same case, do you also have a magnet under the case for phone holders??

**optimistprime3** OP • 7mo ago

I loved that case! Got the same style for my new phone (not a Pixel). Yeah, I had a small magnet under there so it would connect with my car. That section of the case remained intact.

**Mypopsecrets** • 6mo ago

That's so wild, [here's my 6a with case and magnet](#)

I ordered a 9a (hopefully with a less explodey battery) after seeing your post because it was too identical to my setup

[+ 1 more reply](#)**OneEyedC4t** • 8mo ago

Was it the Google charger or an aftermarket? Asking because I'm behind corporate firewall

**optimistprime3** OP • 8mo ago • Edited 8mo ago

It was an Amazon ~~essentials~~ 9W wall charger I've been using for over a year, not just for that device but charging other things with it, too.

ETA: Model PS57CP. I'd thought it was Amazon essentials but it wasn't. It's one of my slower chargers.

**OneEyedC4t** • 8mo ago

Yep, sorry, Amazon will source stuff that's cheaply made because the company is run by someone whose goal is profit, not perfection.



[Skip to main content](#)

Create

[eurestym](#) • 8mo ago

Using a cheap knockoff charger while having your phone under a pile of clothes while charging is probably not a wise idea.

[optimistprime3](#) OP • 8mo ago

I grabbed the charger to check - actually not Amazon essentials, it might've been originally for my long-forgotten Fire tablet, but it was lower wattage which I used knowing it was charging overnight: 9W.

If I'd had the phone under clothes there would've been a lot more damage. It was either resting on the top of the pile that burned or, in the process of me trying to find it in the dark at 4am, I pulled it onto the pile by its USB cable to get it close enough to toss it on the floor where it couldn't burn anything else. It all happened in about 3 seconds, so I don't know.

[a_blue_day](#) • 8mo ago

If it's "another" could you link to the first one?

[optimistprime3](#) OP • 8mo ago

https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1knwuh8/my_google_pixel_6a_spontaneously_com_busted_in_the/ I linked this above as well, it's from 3 weeks ago.

[zlatan1985](#) • 8mo ago

they bricked the 4a with a firmware update that killed the battery, guess its only a matter of time before the 6a. they did a 7a battery replacement program recently too.... seems the a series has a re-occurring problem

[rodrigofernety](#) • 8mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro

I'm afraid now

[Xisrr1](#) • 8mo ago

Why would you grab it

[slfyst](#) • 8mo ago

[Skip to main content](#)

Create

**nobody65535** • 8mo ago

Pixel 9

Sounds like it was on clothes. Maybe not the best idea for trapping heat

**helios-sound** • 8mo ago

Pixel 6a

Maybe a stupid question, but I have my 6a by the bed always but it's never charging through the night... should I still be concerned about this happening?

**fajron123** • 8mo ago

Same, its usually charging on a book on the floor next to my bed

**sovietpandas** • 8mo ago

Why on a book

**fajron123** • 8mo ago

i didnt want it lying on a floor so i took the 1st thing that came to my mind. and i stuck with that

**ithilkir** • 8mo ago

Pixel 6 Pro

NEVER leave your phone charging unattended, any phone can over heat and especially not on a flammable object ... geez



8 more replies

**Flybeck2** • 8mo ago**ithilkir** • 8mo ago

Pixel 6 Pro

Wait, you left your phone charging over night while you slept on top of a pile of clothes?

Obviously nothing should overheat but with ANY electrical piece of equipment left actively charging there's a chance that will happen. Please don't leave things charging unattended and especially not sitting on top of extremely flammable materials.

**curryprogrammer** • 8mo ago

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)**SparklingZone** • 8mo ago

Unacceptable. These kind of issues should threaten the existence of the company who made it if they can't address it!

**horatiobanz** • 8mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

This is how Google can offer 7 years of software updates. They know all of their phones ain't making it to 7 years.

**KashPoe** • 8mo ago

And that's why I keep telling people to not leave their phones charging overnight. Leaving batteries run hot like this for a long period of time (overnight is not good). I know Phones supposedly have a software feature to slow down the charging speed if you do, but still it doesn't look that safe to me. And it's not good for the battery life to do it that long anyway Phones nowadays have fast charging that takes less than 2 hours to fully charge it. Heck my 9 pro xl charges to 70% in just 30 minutes. I charge it when I get up in the morning and I'm good for the day, if not I'll charge it more during the evening.

**Ghostttpro** • 8mo ago**Fun_Cut_4705** • 8mo ago • Edited 8mo ago**[deleted]** • 8mo ago

This right here is why I slow charge over night on a 15W wireless charger. No 65W charging for me while I'm sleeping, thanks.

**optimistprime3** **OP** • 8mo ago

I was only using a 9W charger when this happened. :(

**[deleted]** • 8mo ago

Yeesh... I see that now. Don't know if you edited that in after I said it but I missed that the first time (ADD is not conducive to reading lol).

Did you have insurance through Fi or Pixel Preferred Care?

**optimistprime3** **OP** • 8mo ago

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)

the post.

I had the device protection plan through Fi and that's \$5/month on my bill, but wasn't aware of any other insurance options.



[deleted] • 8mo ago

Pixel Preferred Care is their Apple Care competition and it's just as good. It's more expensive at like \$15 or something I think but it replaces or repairs the device regardless of damage.

Of course that's not going to help you now, but it's worth a look in the future.



1 more reply



OzarkBeard • 8mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

Use charger either from the phone manufacturer or a known, highly rated good brand like ANKER. It's not something to cheap-out on.



[deleted] • 8mo ago



[deleted] • 8mo ago



[deleted] • 8mo ago

I am too scared of lithium batteries. I have never had any fires yet but i am a heavy sleeper...if something happens the damage could be life threatening. I only recharge my batteries when im awake....phone included.



_ritam_b • 8mo ago

Its 2am at night and i have 20% charge on my 6a, got my pre booked bus tickets in the phone, was planning to charge my phone overnight and now i am scared af



1 more reply



respectablechum • 8mo ago

Well my 6 just randomly shut off today even though it was working flawlessly before that. Can't boot it using any of the known ways. Guess they want us to upgrade



nemagaurav • 8mo ago

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**rickastleysanchez** • 8mo ago

Pixel 6a

Please, my 6a, stay good. I have a 3a as a back up, and a Nexus 6p for a back up to the back up. I cannot afford a new phone.

**UrenjBoy** • 8mo ago

I also have a 6a. One of my overheating experience doesn't involve charging. I slept one time with my phone under my pillow and when I woke up in the middle of the night, I was so surprised at how hot it was even though it wasn't charging and hasn't been used for hours. Has anyone else experienced that?

[+ 1 more reply](#)**username-invalid-s** • 8mo ago

Pixel 6

amazon essentials?

[+ 1 more reply](#)**optimistprime3** **OP** • 8mo ago

I do think there are problematic battery signs that aren't being flagged by Google for phones more at risk. Over the approx 2 years I used the phone, it would overheat somewhat often when taking video or being on a video call outside. If the air temp was above 90, I couldn't depend on more than 2-3 minutes of video before it diminished the quality with an overheating warning. That's without the case on, not in direct sunlight, and I live in Arizona so it's over 90 degrees about 1/3 of the year.

The phone sometimes (but not always) would get hot when it was charging. That's why I put it on my lowest wattage charger (9W) and only charged it overnight if the battery was under 20% because I couldn't rely on it making it through the night for my alarms in the morning. Not all 6a seem to have these issues, but if yours overheats under these kinds of conditions, maybe you can get them to swap it out.

Please just don't risk charging it overnight at all but especially if your phone ever gets hot or overheats. Obviously, things can go poorly very quickly. I had 1 accessible outlet in my room for charging my phone and it's next to my bed but no other furniture, so that's why the phone was on my bed. Hindsight teaches you a lot, and changing my routine to partially quick charge my phone as high as I can get it before bed rather than charge it overnight at all will be safer.

As for a replacement, I'm still waiting to hear back from them from their last email where they're checking into things about replacement/upgrade options. The response time has been 20-40 hours for every email exchange, and I'm locked out of even temporarily using an older phone due to 2FA (separate support ticket for that is also slow).



Create



TehWildMan_ • 8mo ago

Damn, the 4a battery SNAFU and now there are reports of 6as on fire.

I can't win rolling the dice with Phones.